JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with 14 years of hands-on experience building and scaling distributed systems at high-traffic companies. I've led technical teams through major architectural decisions, mentored engineers across multiple levels, and consistently shipped systems handling millions of daily transactions. My background spans backend infrastructure, cloud platforms, and database optimization, with a particular focus on reliability and performance under pressure.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra, DynamoDB

Tools and Frameworks: Docker, Terraform, gRPC, Apache Kafka, Nginx

Infrastructure: Linux systems administration, CI/CD pipelines, infrastructure as code

Specializations: Distributed systems, microservices architecture, database scaling, high availability systems

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

TechFlow Systems Ltd

techflow.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led architecture decisions for a microservices platform serving 5 million daily active users across 12 countries.

Designed and implemented a distributed database sharding strategy that reduced query latency by 67% and improved write throughput to 500k ops per second.

Built and mentored a team of 6 senior engineers, conducting weekly architecture reviews and establishing technical standards across the organization.

Established a disaster recovery framework with automated failover mechanisms achieving 99.99% uptime across all production systems.

Senior Staff Engineer

Velocity Data Solutions

velocitydata.co

Liverpool, United Kingdom

September 2018 - February 2022

Architected a real-time data streaming pipeline using Kafka and Apache Flink processing 2 terabytes of data daily for financial services clients.

Reduced infrastructure costs by 42% through comprehensive optimization of Kubernetes clusters and implementing intelligent resource allocation policies.

Mentored 8 junior and mid-level engineers through formal technical mentorship program, with 3 subsequently promoted to senior roles.

Drove migration of legacy monolithic systems to microservices, completing 15 services over 18 months with zero production incidents.

Software Engineer

Digital Innovation Partners

digitalinnovation.net

Liverpool, United Kingdom

June 2010 - August 2018

Built and maintained backend services in Java and Python supporting a SaaS platform with 50,000 paying customers.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing mean time to detection by 73%.

Optimized PostgreSQL queries and database schemas, improving application response times from 800ms to 120ms for critical user workflows.

Contributed to 24/7 on-call rotation, resolving production incidents with an average response time of 8 minutes.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

2006 - 2010

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jrichardson84/distributed-cache-go - An in-memory distributed caching system written in Go with consistent hashing

github.com/jrichardson84/kafka-stream-processor - Production-ready Kafka consumer with batching and error handling patterns

github.com/jrichardson84/postgres-migration-tool - Database migration framework supporting zero-downtime schema changes

github.com/jrichardson84/kubernetes-cost-analyzer - Tool for analyzing and optimizing Kubernetes resource allocation and billing